

NOOR POST

One of fourteen. Open it on the day.



FOR

[Child's name]



Noor Post

[Return address — not set]

ENVELOPE 01 ·
MUHARRAM · INSIDE THE
FLAP

Open together.

🕒 About twenty-five minutes

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

This one has no game in it.

- ① The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- ② The hadith card
- ③ The prints
- ④ Sit with it
- ⑤ The pennant
- ⑥ The postcard

FACT PANEL

Imam Husayn

(peace be upon him)

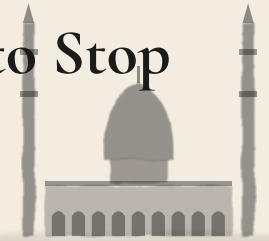
B. 4 AH, MEDINA · D. 61 AH, KARBALA

- **Where and when.** He lived in Medina, in the city his grandfather built the community in, and died about eight hundred miles away on open ground in Iraq that had no town on it and no name most people knew.
- **Who was ruling.** The Umayyad caliph Yazid ibn Muawiya, from Damascus. The order that reached Karbala came through his governor at Kufa, Ubaydullah ibn Ziyad. *Both names are worth saying out loud once — the caliph never came.*
- **The imamate.** About ten years, from 50 AH, from the age of about forty-six. He was an old man by the standards of his time when he set out.
- **What he left.** Names. We know who was with him, one by one, and the lists survive — his brothers, his sons, his companions, and the men who crossed over on the last morning. Nothing else that happened that year in that empire is recorded person by person.
- **Umm al-Banin.** She was married to Imam Ali and had four sons, and all four were at Karbala, and none came back. In the accounts of what she asked afterwards, she asked after Husayn first. *Traditionally told.*
- **Elsewhere in the world.** In the same years, bishops were gathering at Constantinople for a council that ran into 681 CE, arguing over a question of doctrine that had split the empire for fifty years.

He was killed at Karbala in 61 AH, with his family and companions, by the army sent against him by Yazid ibn Muawiya.

ENVELOPE 01 · MUHARRAM

The Man Who Was Sent to Stop Them



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- The army came out of the heat with a thousand horses and nothing left in their water skins. Their commander was a man called Hurr, and his orders were simple. Find Husayn on the road. Do not let him go on, and do not let him turn back.

| ○ Did he stop them?

- He did. He put his thousand men across the road. And then, before he said one word about the orders, he asked for water.

| ○ For his own army?

- For his own army. And Husayn gave it. All of it. His people watered a thousand horses one at a time, tipping the bowls slowly so the animals would not drink too fast and hurt themselves.

| ○ They were there to trap him.

- They were. He watered them anyway.

- Hurr rode alongside them for days after that, closing off every road that turned for home. He was good at his job. When they stopped at Karbala, it was Hurr's men who picked the ground.

| ○ So he was on the wrong side.

- He was on the side he had been sent to be on. There is a difference, and it did not help him sleep.

- Would you have given them the water? Say yes or no now.
- On the last morning the two armies stood facing each other in the cold, and Hurr sat on his horse and shook. A man next to him said he had never once seen him frightened. Hurr said he was not frightened. He said he was choosing, and that he had never had to choose before.
- Then he turned his horse and rode out alone, across the flat empty ground between the two armies, and got down in front of Husayn and asked him a question. He asked whether a man like him — the man who brought the army, who picked the ground — could still be forgiven this late in the day.
- What did he say?
- He said yes. He said it straight away.
- Hurr was given his name on the day he was born. It means the free one. He carried it for a lifetime and used it once, for about ten minutes.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

●◦

Free. That was his name the
whole time.



Then the hadith card.

IMAM HUSAYN SAID

“The true stingy is that who refrains
from greeting.”

Imam Husayn

NOOR POST · THE FOURTEEN

The chain

Every card in this box is one link. Lay all fourteen in order and the chain runs from the Prophet to the last of the twelve, each one passing on what was given.



Fourteen segments · historical order

IN OUR WORDS

Being too mean even to say hello is the worst kind of stingy.

Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims, no. 18. Translated by Badr Shahin,
Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

Sit with it

No game in this one. No points. About ten minutes.

Read this out loud. ● reads. ○ listens.

When Hurr came across, he did not ask to be forgiven quietly, and he did not ask in private. He crossed a mile of open ground where both armies could see him do it, got down, and said it where everyone could hear.

One question.

Hurr had been in the wrong for four days and knew it. What made the fifth day different?

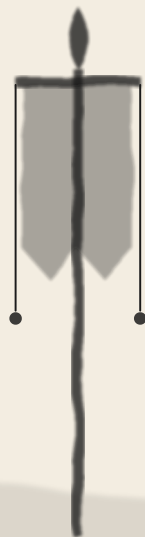
Say it once. Do not discuss it.

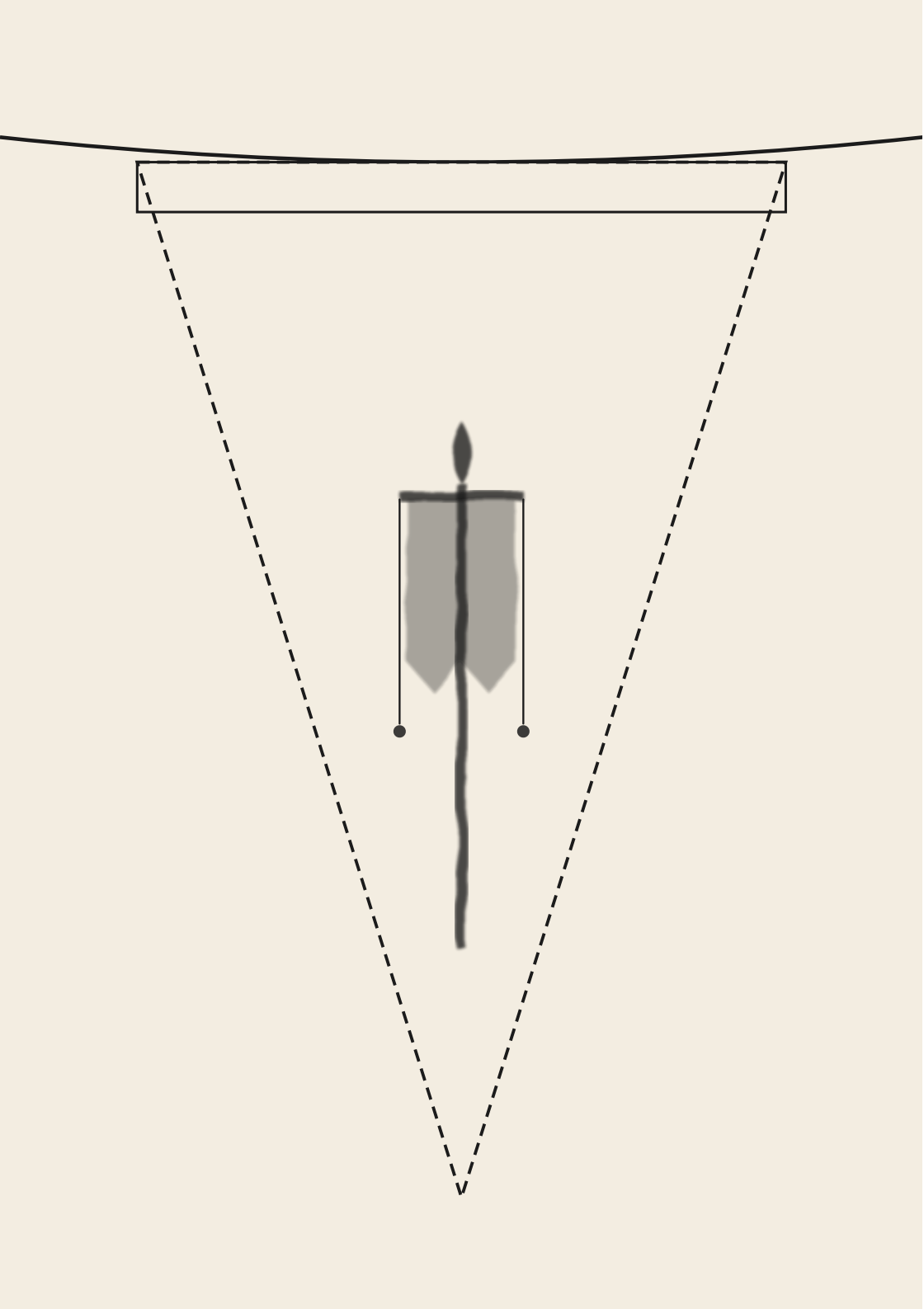
Then sit quietly for two minutes. Both of you. No talking, no phone, nothing to look at.

Two minutes is longer than you think. That is the point.











We opened this one together.

- _____

- _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]

